Transforming Healthcare through Traditional Medicine

Ministry of Ayush's Inspirational Journey



Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal
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In an exclusive interview, **Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal, Hon'ble Union Minister for Ayush & Ports, Shipping and Waterways,** sheds light on the progress and achievements in the Ayush sector under the visionary leadership of **Sh. Narendra Modi, Hon'ble Prime Minister**. He outlines the Ministry's strides in **research, collaboration with international bodies** like World Health Organization (WHO), and achievements in extending public healthcare services, reflecting a concerted effort towards promoting Ayush systems globally and improving healthcare access domestically. Here are some excerpts:

Q: How is the Ministry of Ayush progressing in terms of evidence generation within the field?

The Ministry of Ayush is deeply committed to fostering a **robust research ecosystem**. We have **five research councils** and numerous **national-level institutes** running as autonomous bodies actively engaged in research activities. Notably, our Ayush Research portal houses **over 41 thousand** research studies, with a growing list that includes **150 Covid-19 studies**. We're also focusing on clinical research and have launched initiatives like the **Centre of Excellence scheme** to further our research endeavors.

Q: Could you shed some light on the recent release of ICD-11 Module 2 by WHO in Delhi and its significance?

To be exact, the release of **ICD-11 TM Module 2** by WHO in Delhi is a significant milestone. This module, specifically tailored for traditional medicine systems like **Ayurveda, Siddha, and Unani (ASU), standardizes classifications** of disorders and patterns. This standardization facilitates global understanding and research in these systems, ultimately advancing their reach and acceptance worldwide. Our **Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** termed it an achievement of our country and clearly explained TM Module 2's role and working in his "Mann Ki Baat" latest episode. As he said, this will facilitate not only **research** but also **learning** in academic fields, thereby furthering ASU across the world and in our country.

Q: How is the Ministry collaborating with WHO on various initiatives?

The Ministry of Ayush is working closely with WHO on multiple fronts towards **standard development, digital technology** and research. Apart from the ICD-11 Module 2 release, we've established WHO's **Global Centre for Traditional Medicine** (GCTM) in **Jamnagar**, Gujarat, the first of its kind in any developing nation. **Institute of Training and Research in Ayurveda (ITRA),** Jamnagar and **Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY)** are designated as WHO's collaborative centres for Traditional Medicines. **WHO m-Yoga App** has also been launched and Ministry of Ayush has also signed **3 Project Collaboration Agreements (PCA)**. Ministry has also worked in tandem with WHO on Covid-19. **Benchmark for training** in Ayurveda, Yoga and Unani System of Medicine has also been published

Q: What are some notable achievements in public healthcare that your ministry has accomplished?

Our efforts in public healthcare have yielded significant results. For instance, the **Ayushman Arogya Mandir** program has seen a remarkable increase in beneficiaries, surpassing **17 crore**. We've also developed **22 digital initiatives** to enhance healthcare services, with notable projects like the **Central Research Institute of Yoga** and **Naturopathy** in Assam. Additionally, the **National Ayush Mission** has made substantial progress in operationalizing healthcare centers nationwide, indicating our commitment to extending healthcare access to all. .

In recent years, the **Ministry of Ayush** in India has spearheaded transformative initiatives under the visionary leadership of **Sh. Narendra Modi, the Hon'ble Prime Minister**, and led by **Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal, the Hon'ble Union Minister for Ayush and Ports, Shipping & Waterways**. These efforts have not only elevated traditional medicine systems but have also positioned India as a global leader in holistic healthcare. Let's delve into the impactful and inspirational work undertaken by the Ministry of Ayush, showcasing its achievements and contributions.

ICD-11 (TM) Chapter 26 Module-2 Launch: A Milestone in Global Healthcare

On Jan 10, 2024, the World Health Organization (WHO) and the Ministry of Ayush launched the **ICD-11 Traditional Medicine Chapter 26 Module-2 version**, paving the way for global implementation. This initiative **indexes terminologies** from Ayurveda, Unani, and Siddha under ICD-11 TM Chapter 26 Module 2, facilitating **international coding of diseases and disorders**. With **529 entries**, this move signifies global recognition and acceptance of Indian traditional medicine systems, **enhancing healthcare standardization** and research opportunities worldwide.

WHO Collaborations: Nurturing Global Partnerships

Apart from the establishment of the first and only Global Centre for Traditional Medicine (WHO GCTM) in Jamnagar, Gujarat the Ministry of Ayush has collaborated extensively with WHO, with initiatives like the WHO Traditional Medicine Global Summit and the establishment of the WHO Collaborative Centre in Traditional Medicine (Yoga). Through Project Collaboration Agreements and